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PDF parsing for testing involves **extracting text, tables, and images from PDF files to validate data, ensure layout consistency, or prepare documents for Retrieval Augmented Generation (RAG)**. Common techniques include using libraries like [PyPDF](#), [pdfminer](#), or AI-powered tools like [LlamaParse](#) and [Docparser](#) to convert unstructured PDFs into machine-readable formats. 

Key PDF Parsing & Testing Techniques

- **Text & Data Extraction:** [PyPDF](#) is commonly used for basic text extraction, while AI-powered parsers like [Parsio](#) or [Airparser](#) can handle complex or structured data.
- **Layout-Aware Parsing:** [Docling](#) (by IBM) and [Unstructured.io](#) excel at maintaining document structure for RAG pipelines.
- **OCR (Optical Character Recognition):** For scanned or non-searchable PDFs, tools like [DeepSeek OCR](#), [Mistral OCR](#), and [Nutrients Processor API](#) are used to extract text and tables.
- **PDF Comparison Testing:** [DiffPDF](#) enables visual or text-based comparisons of two PDF files to identify differences. 

Common Tools and Libraries

- **Open Source:** [PyPDF](#), [PDFMiner](#), [Docling](#).
- **AI/Managed Services:** [LlamaParse](#), [Nanonets](#), [Docsumo](#). 

Use Cases